

How to use these sheets.



The symbols and shorthand make the guides quick to scan. Here are the distinctions that are less obvious at first glance.

Reading the calendar

Bright shades show the usual sowing and harvest months for temperate climates. For the purposes of this guide, a temperate climate is considered as being lowland England, US zones 8 to 9. Muted shades show less usual options for warmer climates. Use local conditions and the crop’s advice to choose your timing.

Growing calendar

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
SOW												
HARVEST												

Bright: usual months · Muted: less usual

Usual

Temperate climates

Sow

Harvest

Less usual

Warmer climates

Sow

Harvest

Difficulty rating

Some vegetables, such as radishes, are great for beginners, whereas crops like celery and cauliflower will defeat even experienced gardeners in a bad season. The scale will give you an idea of how easy a crop is to grow, and how tolerant it is of adverse growing conditions.

DIFFICULTY

Medium

3/5

1

2

3

4

5

5

Core needs

An under-supply of sun, water or manure can damage some plants, while too much can harm others. Use this as a guide to core vegetable requirements.

Sun

3/5

Water

4/5

Nutrition

2/5

1

Low demand

5

High demand

VEGETABLE GROWING · CHEAT SHEETS

HOW TO USE THESE SHEETS